



Under The Nose - Game Design Document

Title	Under The Nose
Overview	You play as a journalist in this stealth game. Your objective is to expose Ace Chemicals' illegal waste dumping.

1. Introduction

1.1. High Concept

A game about **vulnerability and verification**. The player cannot fight; they can only observe and distract. The goal is to filter truth from lies.

1.2. USP: Mechanics of Tension

- **Disempowerment:** The player has zero offensive capabilities. There is no gun, no takedown, no tranquillisers. Survival is strictly binary: *Avoidance* or *Failure*.
- **The "Lean" Lifeline:** The only tool the player has to gather information safely. It bridges the gap between total cover (blindness) and total

exposure (death).

- **Information Filtering:** The "Boss Fight" is not an enemy, but a folder of documents. The player must use logic to secure a high score.

2. Gameplay Mechanics

The gameplay of *Under The Nose* is defined by a strict **Non-Lethal, High-Consequence** loop. The player has no health bar. The fail state is binary (Detected = Game Over). The experience is divided into three distinct phases of operation:

1. **Infiltration (The Physical Loop):** The player navigates complex geometry (vents, rafters, tight corridors) while managing their noise to avoid predictable AI patrols.
2. **Acquisition (The Exploration Loop):** The player identifies and interacts with potential evidence assets scattered across the map. There is no limit on item collection. The player has to find the correct pieces through the clutter.
3. **Verification (The Logic Loop):** The primary differentiator. Before exfiltration, the player must review their inventory and filter Contradictory/Irrelevant data from Valid Evidence.

The challenge is not simply reaching the finish line, but reaching it with the correct dataset and to secure an **S-Rank**.

2.1. Locomotion & Physics

2.1.1. Player Stance & Noise

- **Standing:** Standard height. Footsteps emit noise based on Surface Material (Refer Section 7.2).
- **Crouching:** Reduces collision height by 50%. Footsteps are silent on all surfaces except *Water/Puddles*.

2.1.2. The Lean Mechanic

- **Input:** Q (Left) / E (Right).
- **Implementation:** The Camera Component interpolates to the offset Lean Offset (Refer Section 7.1).
- **Safety Logic:** The root `CapsuleComponent` (Hitbox) **DOES NOT MOVE**.
- **Detection Balance:**

- The AI casts visibility rays to two bones: `Spine_01` and `Head`.
- If AI sees `Spine_01`: Full Detection Speed.
- If AI sees *only* `LeanVisibilityProbe` (Leaning): Reduced Detection Speed.
- *Result*: You are not invisible, but you have significantly more time to scout than if you stepped out fully.

2.1.3. Throwable Objects

- Player has the ability to throw objects to distract guards
- The noise level is based on Throwable List (Refer Section 7.3)

2.2. Stealth & AI

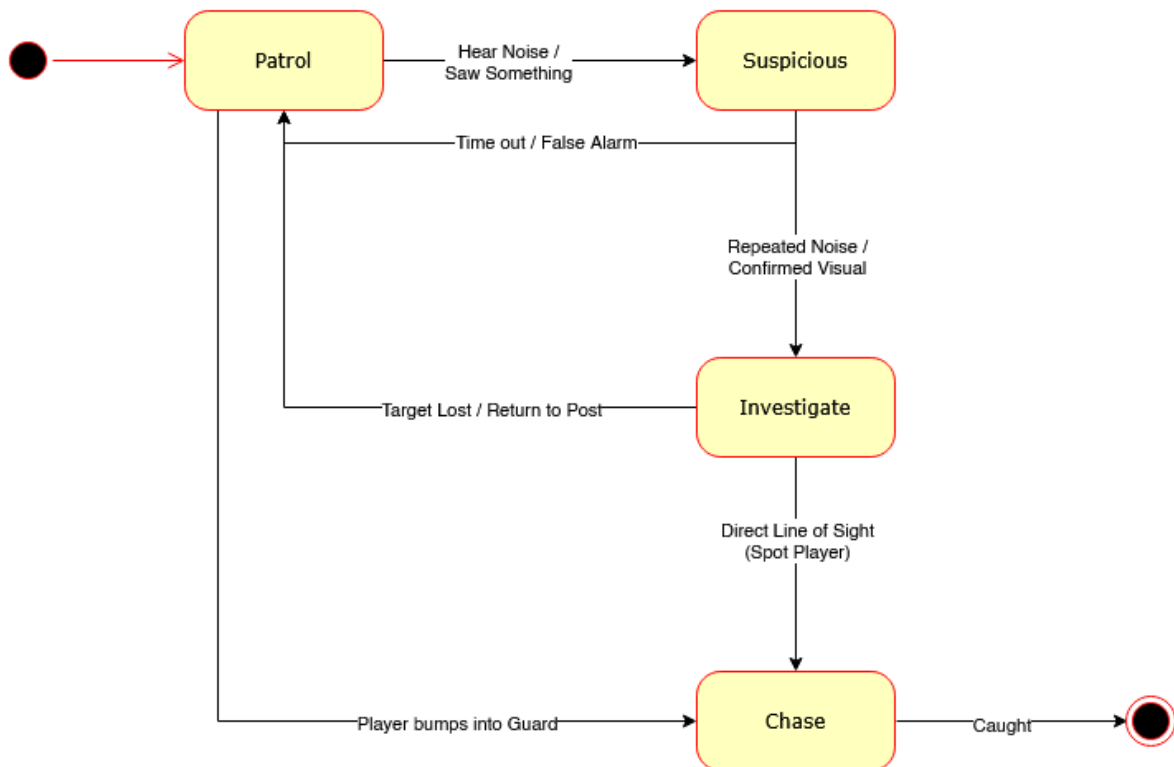
2.2.1. Detection Logic

- **Visual**: AI uses a "Vision Cone" attached to the head bone.
- **Audio**: AI listens for `MakeNoise` events.
 - *Note*: Audio does not trigger "Attack." Audio triggers "Investigate" (Walk to sound location).

2.2.2. Diegetic Feedback (UI)

- **Visual**: Screen Vignette.
 - *Safe*: No vignette.
 - *Suspicious*: Edges blur slightly.
 - *Detected*: Edges turn dark/black and tunnel vision occurs.
- **Audio**:
 - *Safe*: Ambient room tone.
 - *Near Threat*: High-frequency drone ("Tinnitus" effect) fades in.
 - *Detected*: Sharp orchestral sting.

AI State Diagram



2.3. Evidence System

The game calculates the final score upon exfiltration using the following logic:

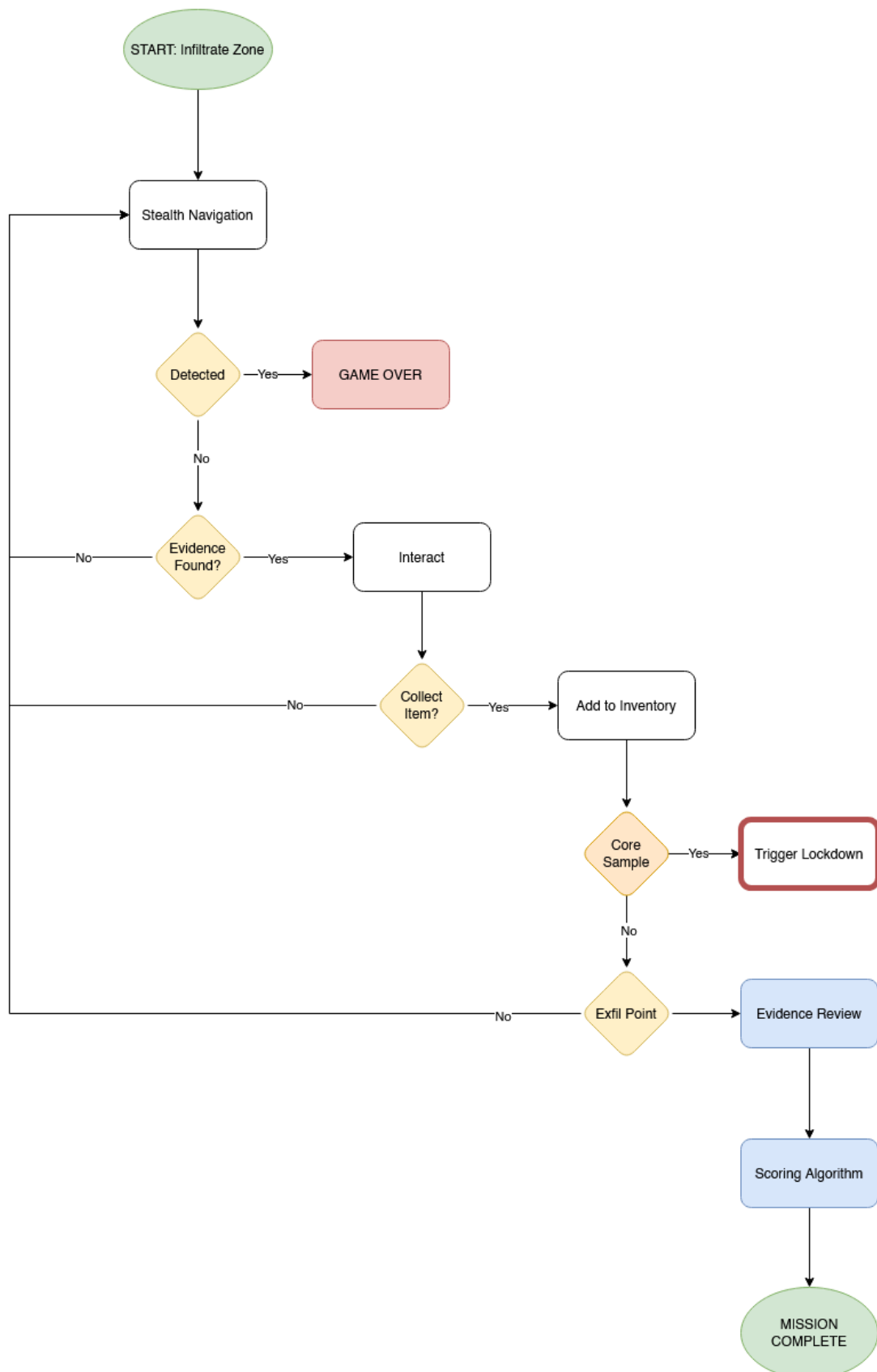
Scoring Formula (Refer Section 7.4)

The Mission Item (Core Sample): This is a mandatory Key Item required to trigger exfiltration. It does **not** occupy a scoring slot.

- The heavy penalty for **Contradictory** evidence forces players to actually read documents, raising the skill ceiling.
- While the player's inventory is unlimited during the mission, the final score is calculated *only* on the 5 items manually selected for the 'Submission Folder' during the Evidence Review phase.

2.4. Core Gameplay Loop

Core Gameplay Loop



3. Story & Characters

3.1. Miles (The Journalist)

- **Profile:** A "ground reporter" for *The Veritas Collective*, a struggling independent studio dedicated to true journalism. He isn't a hero, he is a professional terrified of being caught. However, he is motivated by the moral weight of the story.
- **Goals:**
 1. **Infiltrate:** Bypass Ace Security without triggering a lockdown.
 2. **Verify:** Secure undeniable proof of toxic dumping (Quality > Quantity).
 3. **Survive:** Exfiltrate with the data intact to publish the story.
- **Traits:** Asthmatic (Run/Panic causes heavy breathing audio), Tech-savvy (Can hack basic doors), Non-violent.
- **Note:** Miles' heavy breathing and heartbeat audio are for immersion and player-side tension only. They do not trigger AI 'Investigate' events.

3.2. Ace Security (The Antagonists)

- **Profile:** "Cleaners." Not standard mall cops. Ex-military contractors hired to protect corporate secrets, not people.
- **Visuals:** Tactical vests, face-concealing balaclavas (dehumanising), flash-lights attached to rifles.
- **Bark Lines:** They don't shout insults. They speak in codes. "Sector 4 clear." "Anomaly detected." "Zeroing in."

4.1. Design Philosophy

The Constrictor: The level is designed to create a rhythm of **Tension (Tight Spaces)** followed by **Release (Open Spaces)**. We use light to guide the player (subconscious pathing) and sound to punish rushing.

4.2. Zone Breakdown & Flow

Zone 1: The Perimeter (Tutorial)

- **Layout:** Linear "Corridor". Moonlight, rain, mud.
- **Flow:**
 1. **Spawn:** Player starts outside the fence.
 2. **Obstacle (Hard Gate):** A locked gate with a guard facing it.
 3. **Solution:** Find **Brick** (Physics Object) → Throw at Dumpster → Guard investigates Noise → Crouch through hole in fence.
- **Design Goal:** Teach that violence is impossible and distraction is key.
- **Evidence (Tutorial Item):**
 - **#01 (Irrelevant):** *Guard Duty Roster*. (Location: Guard Booth).
 - *Purpose:* Teaches the "Interact/Collect" mechanic in a safe environment.

Zone 2: The Warehouse (Acoustic Risk)

- **Layout:** High-ceiling storage bay filled with shipping containers.
- **The "High Road" (Rusted Grates):**
 - Catwalks offer vertical safety (visual cover), but are made of **Rusted Metal**.
 - *Mechanic:* Moving faster than **CrouchSpeed** creates a **MakeNoise** event. Guards below will look up and spot the player.
- **The "Low Road" (Patrol Hell):**
 - Ground level. Fast movement possible on concrete, but high guard density.
 - *Hazard:* **Chemical Sludge Puddles**. Walking through them creates loud splash sounds.
- **Evidence Distribution:**
 - **#02 Valid (Low Road Exclusive):** *Manifest 409*. (Text: "Content: Unmarked Toxic Sludge").
 - **#03 Valid (High Road Exclusive):** *Ventilation Schematic*. (Text: "Filtration Systems Bypassed").
 - **#04 Contradictory:** *Safety Inspection Cert*. (Text: "All containers sealed/safe"). (Location: Entrance Desk).

- **#05 Irrelevant:** *Forklift Repair Manual*. (Location: Break Room).

Zone 3: The Offices (Labyrinth & Tension)

- **Layout:** Tight winding corridors, cubicles, glass walls.
- **Flow:**
 - **Pacing Shift:** Claustrophobic. Long sight lines are gone.
 - **Mechanic Check:** The **Lean (Q/E)** is mandatory here to check intersections before crossing.
 - **Key Objective:** Retrieve "Server Room Key-card" from the Manager's Office.
- **Evidence Distribution:**
 - **#06 Valid:** *Email: "Night Shift"*. (Text: "Dump waste at 02:00 AM"). (Location: Manager's PC).
 - **#07 Valid:** *Payroll Ledger*. (Text: "Bribe Payment: Inspector Davis"). (Location: Filing Cabinet).
 - **#08 Valid:** *Memo: "Burn The Files"*. (Text: "The press is sniffing around"). (Location: Shredder Bin).
 - **#09 Contradictory:** *PR Statement*. (Text: "Ace Chemicals: 100% Green Energy"). (Location: Printer).
 - **#10 Contradictory:** *Internal Audit*. (Text: "No irregularities found"). (Location: Meeting Room).
 - **#11 Irrelevant:** *Employee Birthday Card*. (Location: Cubicle 1).
 - **#12 Irrelevant:** *Lunch Menu*. (Location: Kitchenette).

Zone 4: The Lab (The Climax)

- **Layout:** Circular room. Central "Vat" surrounded by outer ring walkways.
- **Flow:**
 1. **Infiltration:** Guards patrol the outer ring. The player must time their movement to reach the center.
 2. **The Trigger:** Interacting with the **Core Sample** triggers the "Lockdown" (Red Emergency Lights, Blast Shutters close main exit).

3. **Exfiltration:** Player must use the Maintenance Vents (now unlocked) to backtrack to the River while guards enter "Search Mode."

- **Evidence Distribution:**

- **MISSION ITEM: The Core Sample.** (Location: Central Vat). *Triggers Lockdown.*
- **#13 Contradictory:** *Lab Report: "Fish Kill".* (Text: "Local wildlife mortality rate 0.09%"). (Location: Microscope).
- **#14 Valid:** *Chemical Formula.* (Text: "Highly Carcinogenic Compound"). (Location: Whiteboard).
- **#15 Contradictory:** *Water Purity Report.* (Text: "River samples normal"). (Location: Supervisor Desk).
- **#16 Irrelevant:** *Safety Goggles.* (Location: Bench).

5. Menus & Wireframes

5.1. Main Menu (3D Scene)

- **Concept:** "The River"
- **Visual:** The camera floats just above the surface of a polluted river (Murky green/brown water). Vegetation is scarce due to pollutants.
- **Function:**
 - *New Game:* Launches the new level
 - *Settings:* Camera pans to another sign with settings on top of it. The settings menu contains

Game:

- Mouse Sensitivity

Video:

- Display Mode
- Scalability
- VSync
- Texture Quality

- Shadow Quality
- Detail Level
- Effects Quality
- Shader Quality
- Anisotropic Filtering
- Anti-Aliasing
- Post Processing Quality

Audio:

- Master
- Music
- SFX
- Voice

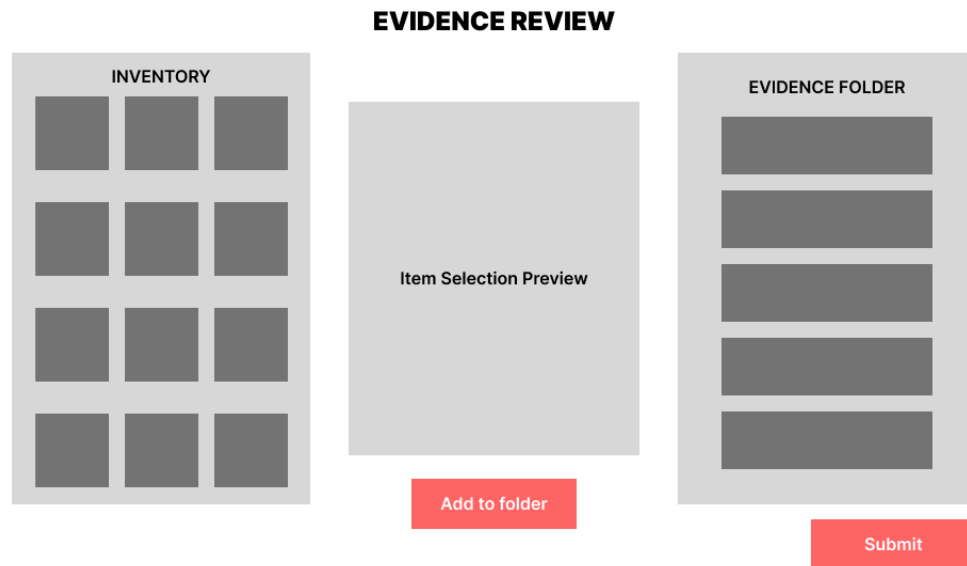
Buttons:

- **Apply:** Applies setting
- **Back:** back to menu/game
- **Defaults:** Restore default settings

- *Quit:* Quits the game

5.2. Evidence Review UI

- **Style:** An Overlay of Miles' Camera Screen.
- **Layout (Grid):**
 - **Left Column (Inventory):** A scrollable list of 10-12 collected items.
 - **Center (Preview):** Large view of the selected document/photo.
 - **Right Column (Submission Folder):** 5 Empty Slots.
- **Interaction:**
 - Click Item on Left → Display in Center.
 - Button "ADD TO FOLDER" → Moves item to Right Column.
 - Button "SUBMIT STORY" → Triggers End Game calculation.



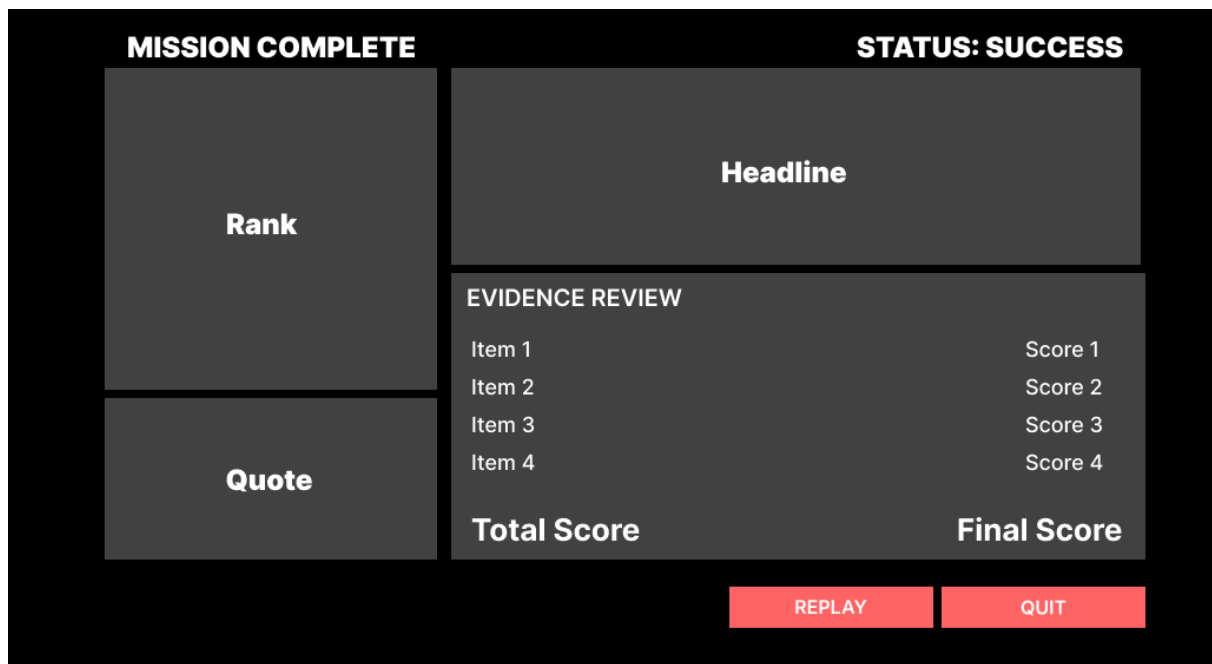
5.3. Pause Menu

Buttons:

- *Resume*
- Settings - Opens the settings UI widget on a blurred background
- *Main Menu*
- *Quit*

5.4. Result Screen

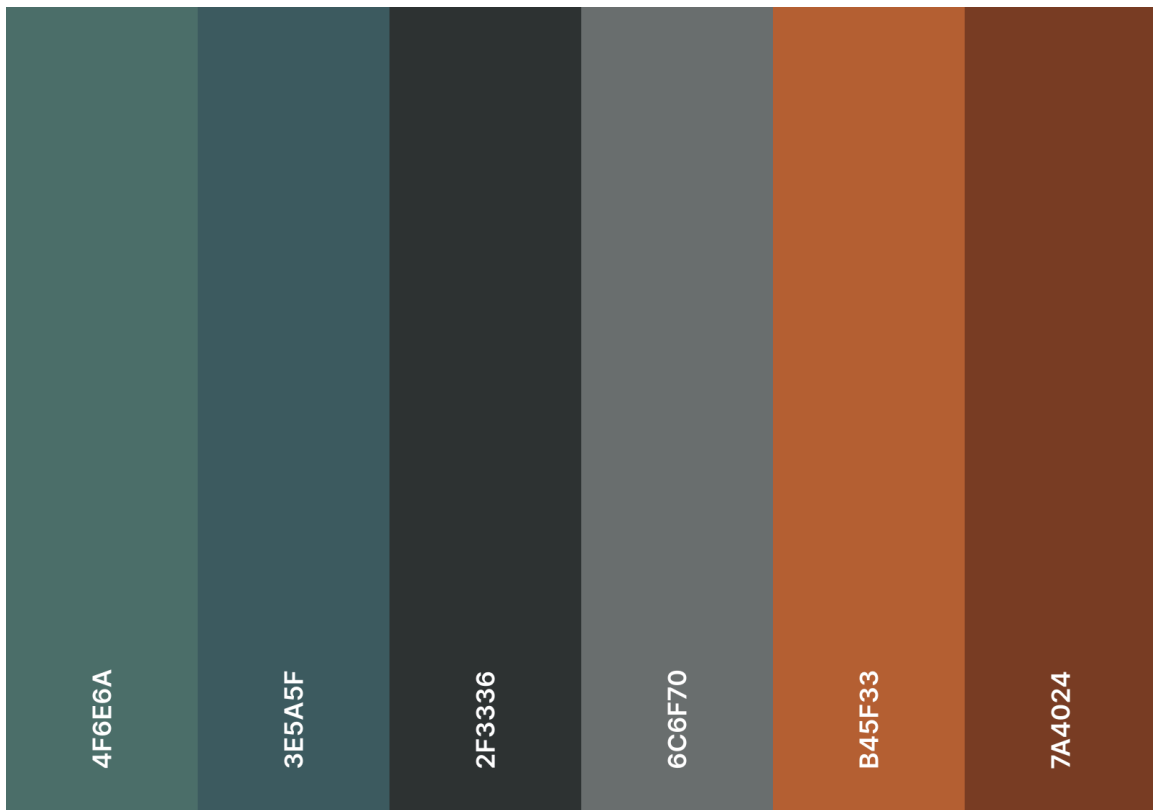
- **Style:** A full-screen overlay, stylized as a **Dark Mode Digital Ledger** or terminal output, contrasting the bright, in-world camera view.
- **Elements:**
 - Rank, Quote and Headline all are based on the player's final score.
 - Mission Status is Success if player get's any rank above C otherwise its failure
 - Evidence review shows each item being evaluated and the final score



6. Visual Direction

6.1. Color Palette

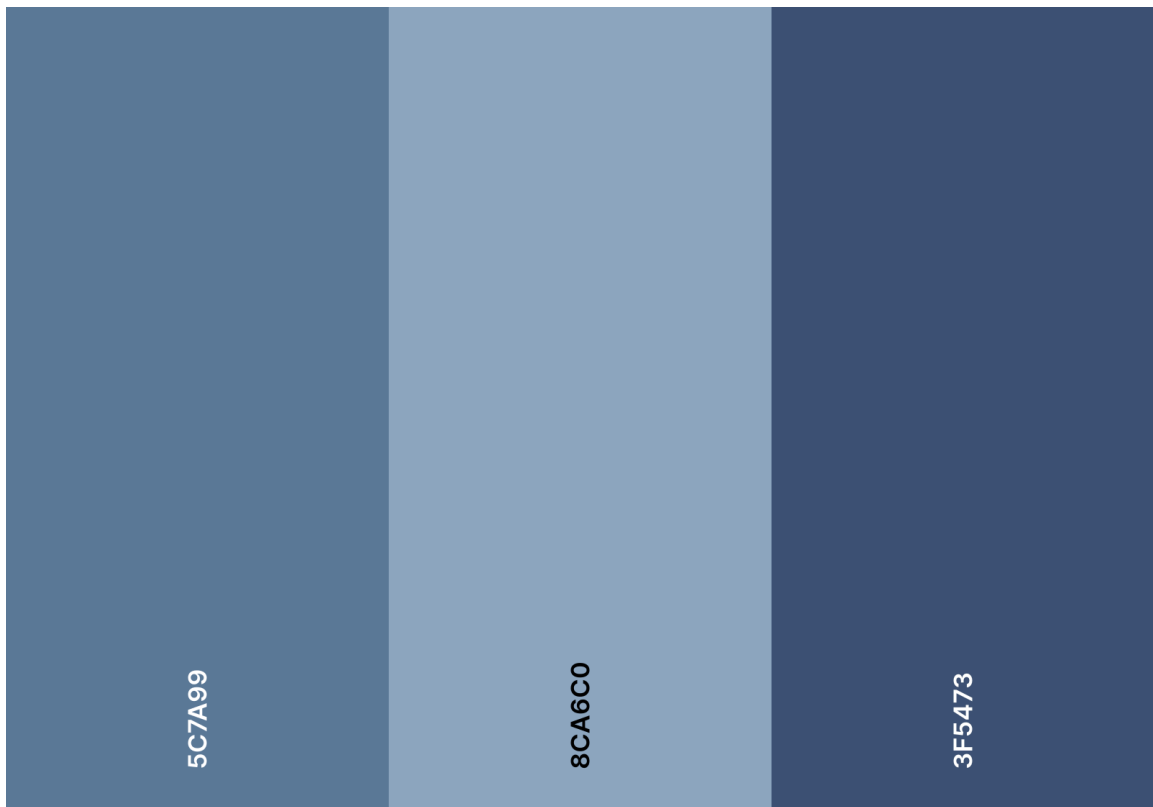
- **Environment:** Desaturated Teals, Greys, and Rust Oranges (Industrial decay).



Environment

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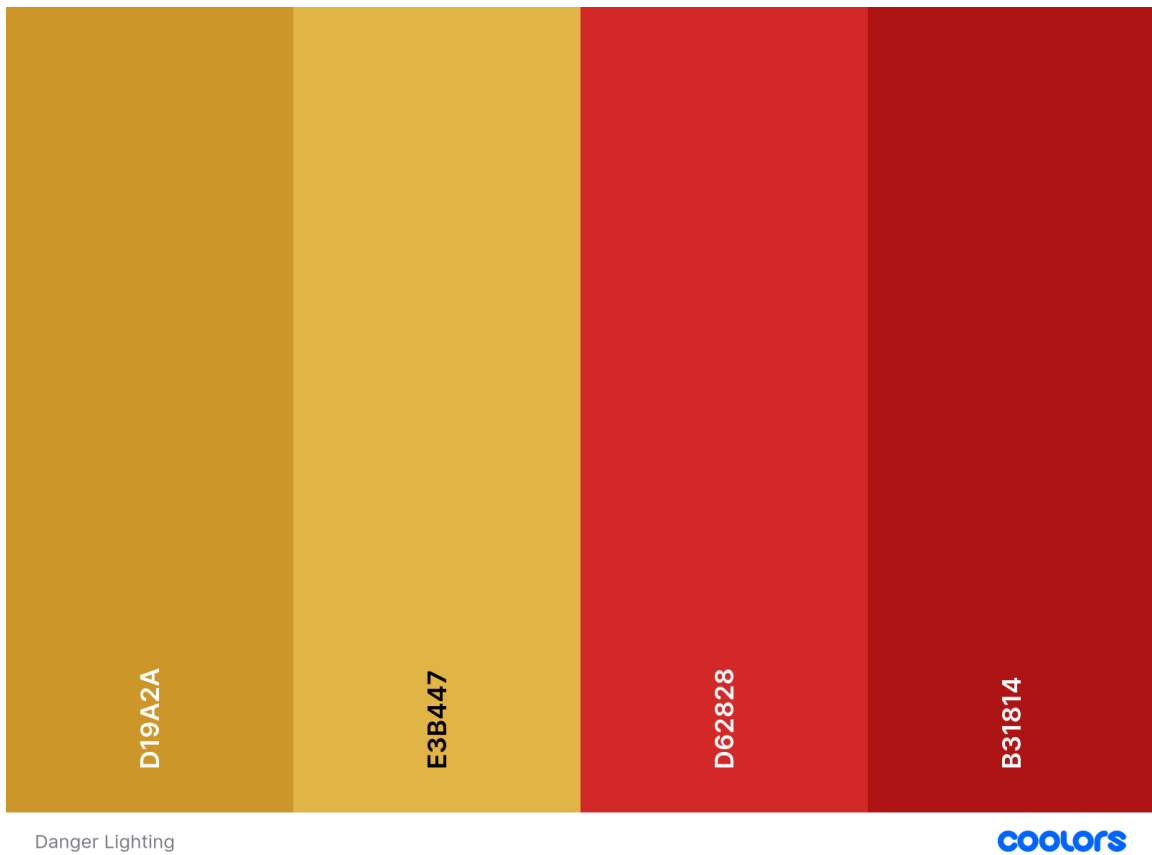
- **Lighting (Safe):** Cool Blue / Moonlight.



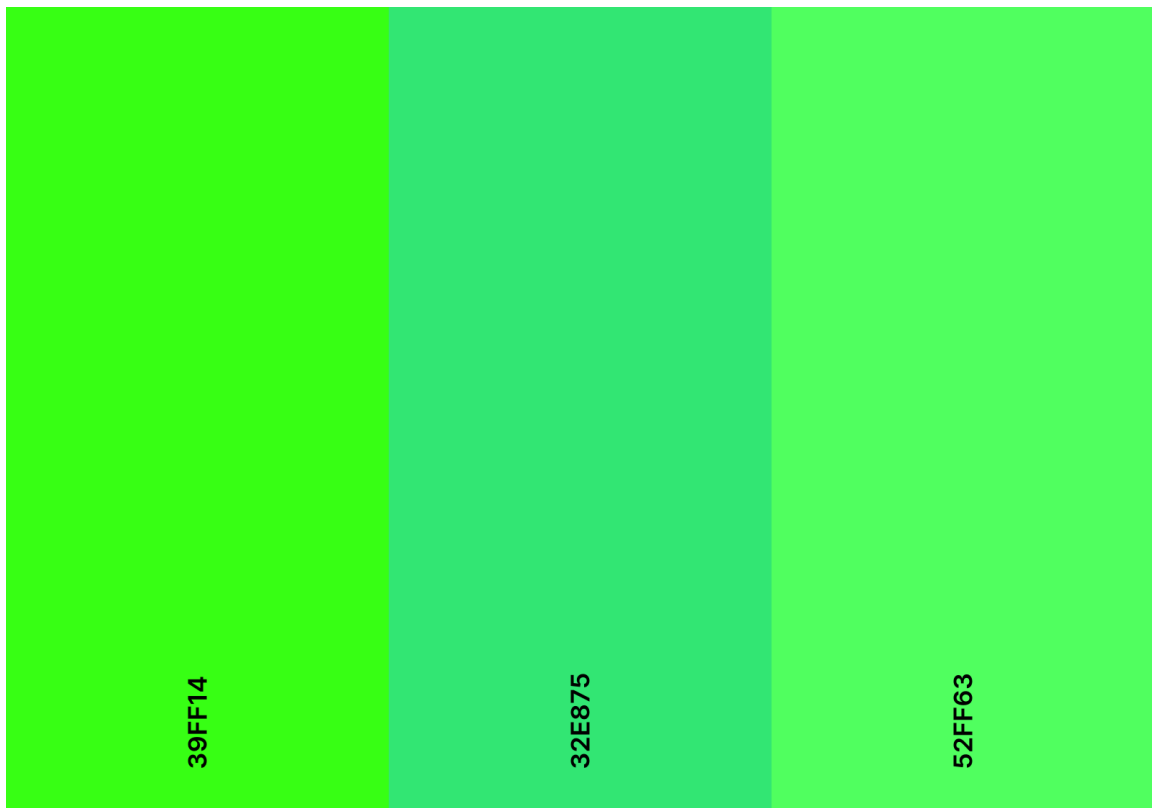
Safe Lighting

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- **Lighting (Danger):** Sodium Vapor Yellow (Streetlights) or Emergency Red (Alarms).



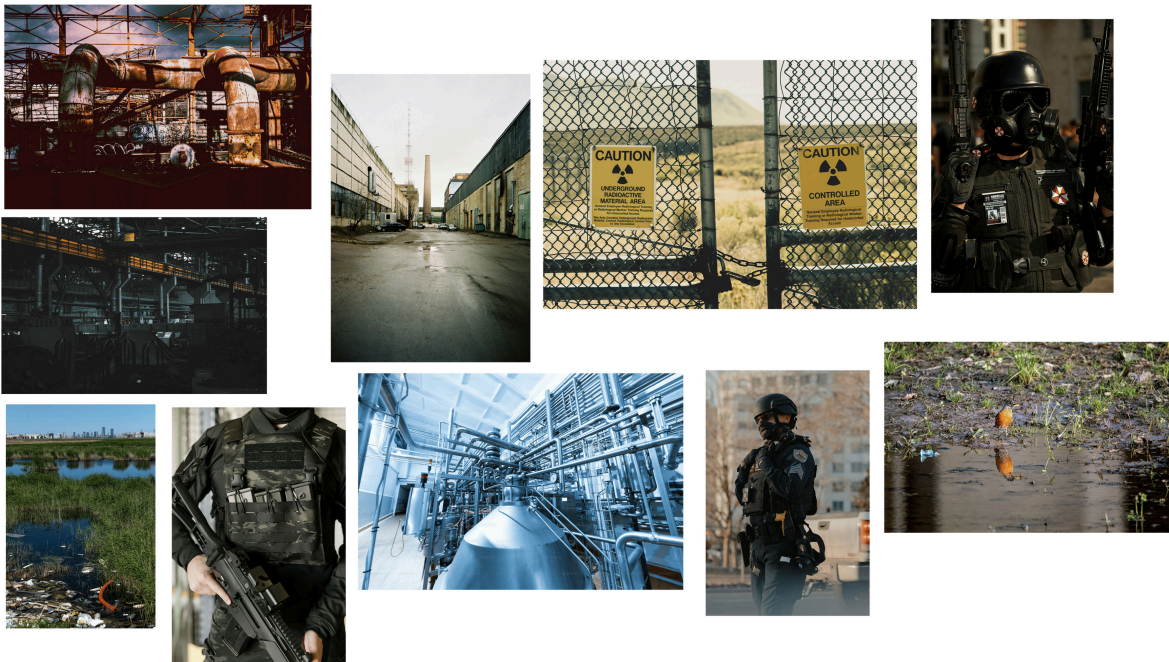
- **Objective:** bright, unnatural "Toxic Green" (Glow-sticks/Chemicals).



Toxics

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6.2. Mood Board



7. GLOBAL CONFIGURATION

7.1. Movement Metrics

- **BaseWalkSpeed** : 400.0 units/sec
- **CrouchSpeed** : 200.0 units/sec
- **LeanAngle** : 15.0 degrees
- **LeanOffset** : 35.0 units (Y-axis)

7.2. Surface Material List

- **PM_Concrete** : Standard Volume (1.0x)
- **PM_Carpet** : Silent (0.0x)
- **PM_MetalGrate** : Loud (1.5x) + Metallic Clank SFX
- **PM_Water** : Splash Sound (1.2x). Even audible when crouching

7.3. Throwable Objects List

- **Empty Can** : Low noise radius (500u). Light mass. Bounces. Good for precise lures.
- **Glass Bottle** : High noise radius (1200u). Medium mass. Shatters on impact. Good for clearing a large room.
- **Brick** : Medium noise (800u). Heavy mass. No bounce. Short throw distance.

7.3. Stealth & AI

- **NoiseRadius_Walk** : 800.0 units
- **NoiseRadius_Crouch** : 0.0 units
- **DetectionTime_Direct** : 2.5 seconds
- **DetectionTime_Peripheral** : 3.0 seconds
- **DetectionTime_Lean** : 4.0 seconds

7.4. Scoring System

7.4.1. Scoring Tiers (Rank)

- **Score_Valid_Evidence** : +20 pts

- **Score_Irrelevant_Evidence** : -5 pts (Time waster)
- **Score_Contradictory_Evidence** : -15 pts (Active sabotage of case)
- **CoreSampleBonus** : +100 pts
- $\text{Score} = (\text{Valid} \times \text{Score_Valid_Evidence}) + (\text{Irrelevant} \times \text{Score_Irrelevant_Evidence}) + (\text{Contradictory} \times \text{Score_Contradictory_Evidence}) + \text{CoreSampleBonus}$

7.4.2. Scoring Tiers (Rank)

Rank	Score	Newspaper Heading	Quote
S (Pulitzer)	200	ACE CHEMICALS SHUT DOWN: TOXIC COVER-UP EXPOSED	A flawless investigation that will redefine journalism for a generation.
A (Front Page)	195 to 199	FEDERAL PROBE LAUNCHED INTO ACE CHEMICALS	Exceptional work. The narrative is airtight and the impact undeniable
B (Page 6)	160 to 194	ACE CHEMICALS DENIES 'BASELESS' POLLUTION ALLEGATIONS	Solid facts secured, but contradictory noise hindered publication credibility.
C (Blogpost)	100 to 159	LOCAL WILDLIFE DEATHS RULED 'NATURAL CAUSES'	Insufficient data integrity; easily discredited by corporate P.R.
F (Redacted)	<100	INTRUDER NEUTRALIZED AT ACE FACILITY	Source compromised; no publishable information retrieved.

7.5. Collectable Items

ID	Item Name	Zone	Type
01	Guard Roster	1	Irrelevant
02	Manifest 409	2 (Low Road)	Valid
03	Vent Schematics	2 (High Road)	Valid
04	Safety Cert	2	Contradictory
05	Forklift Manual	2	Irrelevant
06	Email: Night Dump	3	Valid
07	Payroll Ledger	3	Valid
08	Memo: Burn Files	3	Valid
09	PR Statement	3	Contradictory
10	Internal Audit	3	Contradictory
11	Birthday Card	3	Irrelevant
12	Lunch Menu	3	Irrelevant
13	Lab Report	4	Contradictory
14	Chemical Formula	4	Valid
15	Purity Report	4	Contradictory
16	Safety Goggles	4	Irrelevant